



A. Any kind of infrastructure development plan takes time to complete. There are some basic and important issues to be resolved like rehabilitation, especially in a city like Mumbai where almost every piece of land has been encroached. Until the State rehabilitates the people it is difficult to start any work. In Mumbai the MMRDA, MSRDC and the Municipal Corporation are handling the rehabilitation work. There are various projects in the pipeline; we have already started building various flyovers. The Bandra-Worli Sea Link project is expected to be completed in 2009. We are in the process of holding Bhoomi Pujan in January 2009 to start the Sewri Nhava Sheva project by MMRDA with an investment of Rs. 6,000 crore. Then, there are other projects like the Mono-Rail that is likely to start next month. It will be ready in a period of two years. The only issue left un-addressed would be the waterway for which we have already issued tenders and are waiting for fresh applications.

Q. How are you planning to tackle the power shortage problem in the State?

A. It is the main issue on our agenda. In the last five years we have added 2000 Mega Watts to the power generation capacity. Even the Dabhol Power Plant has been restarted and is generating 1200 Mega Watts of power. We are also getting power from the two projects Parli and Paras that are generating 500 Mega Watts of power. By 2012 we plan to make Maharashtra a load shedding free State. Many private and others Government projects are underway to address the problem.

Q. Which are the new irrigation projects that have been launched? Which parts of Maharashtra stand to benefit from these?

A. The State's irrigation project "Indra Sagar" in Vidarbha has been given the status of being a national project. It is still under construction and the districts around Vidarbha region will benefit from this project. Then there are link-up borages in Godavari and Mandra basin these will ensure supply of water for the whole year. Farmers can pump this water for agriculture. Various other initiatives like the intra river connectivity projects are in the pipeline. Dry land farming is the main problem and we are looking to tackle this problem.

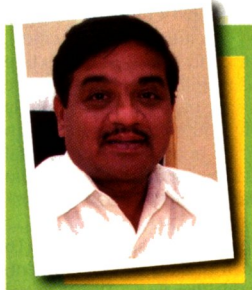
Q. You had proposed food processing parks and textile parks in the backward regions. How many such projects have been implemented and where?



A. As a value addition to farming we are planning to come up with food processing parks in important areas like Marathwada, Western Maharashtra, Vidarbha and Nashik. This is being done so that the farmers benefit by quality improvement for exports. Textile parks under the Textile Scheme have been introduced by the Government of India, it is being implemented in Ichalkaranji and Kolhapur where powerlooms are located. Bombay Rayon will also start projects in Osmanabad, Latur, Mumbai and Amravati.

Q. What steps has the Government taken to promote agriculture and horticulture in the State and what is the investment made in such projects?

A. The State of Maharashtra ranks #1 in horticulture. For horticulture development the State is providing funds under the Employment Guarantee Scheme (EGS). Under this scheme the Government is taking initiatives to protect private land. Around 14 lakh hectare of land is under the horticulture plan and we are able to export major fruits like alphonso mangoes, kesar, banana and grapes to other countries. The funds depend on the Government decisions from time to time.



Shri R. R. Patil
Hon'ble Deputy Chief Minister
of Maharashtra

Known as 'Mr Clean' in political circles, R. R. Patil's career graph from a Zilla Parishad member to the Deputy Chief Minister's chair in Mumbai has been marked by impressive achievements, astute organisational skills and result-oriented leadership. His strong rural roots helped Patil identify the needs of the villages and democratise the functioning of Panchayati Raj institutions. An advocate by profession, Patil has earned the tag of an "Efficient Minister."

Popularly known as 'Aba', Patil has been strongly instrumental in implementing the following initiatives.

The Mahatma Gandhi Dispute Free Village Campaign is one the first projects initiated by Shri R. R. Patil. Starting last Independence Day i.e. August 15, 2007, this project aims to settle the village level cases in the village itself with a focus on the rural sector. Shri R. R. Patil also made a provision of Rs. 11 Crore to award the successful villages under the Mahatma Gandhi Dispute Free Village Campaign. To make this scheme even more effective, he encouraged contribution of Peoples' Courts. The decisions of such courts now will be recorded as affidavits and will be treated as the orders of the Peoples' Courts. It is with his efforts that we witnessed inclusion of a new Section 292-A in the Indian Penal Code 1860 to make the Mahatma Gandhi Dispute Free Village Campaign more effective.

Modernization of Police Force: Shri R. R. Patil initiated steps towards modernization of our Police force. Government of Maharashtra (Home Department) announced its decision on October 10, 2008 to present the Governor's Award for approximately 35,800 Police Patils in the State from 2008. The prize will comprise of a citation signed by the Governor and cash prize of Rs. 5000/-. Every year, 33 awards for the 33 districts will be distributed on the eve of the Maharashtra Day i.e. 1st of May. Shri R. R. Patil was also instrumental in lobbying with the State Government which has taken a policy decision to establish the Maharashtra State Security Council. This Council will give policy advice to the State Government to increase efficiency of the Police force, help the Government in establishing standards of efficiency, take periodic review of the Police force, collect statistical data about Police work and guide the State Government in resource mobilization. Thanks to the establishment of this Council, the State Police will not only become autonomous but will also reduce political interference in Police work.

Issues of Secularism, Terrorism and Naxalism: Shri R. R. Patil is a staunch believer of secularism and looks at terrorism as one of the most important social issue to be addressed in the country. His endeavors bore fruit when the State Government sanctioned development works to the tune of Rs. 5.16 Crore in the Naxal affected Gadchiroli and Gondia districts. As per this proposal, 170 villages in Gadchiroli and 2 villages in Gondia will get Rs. 3 lakh each for development works. This special scheme is also applicable to other naxal affected districts in the State viz. Nanded, Bhandara & Chandrapur. The tenure of this special action drive for overall development of the naxal-affected parts of the 6 naxal affected districts in the State was extended till March 2008. A provision of Rs. 1,700 lakhs has been made in the 2007-08 budget for this purpose. The State Government has established a committee under the Chairmanship of Shri V. G. Palshikar, former Judge of Mumbai High Court, to identify the shortcomings in the acts of atrocities so that it can be strictly implemented. The State CID will be restructured and fortified to fight the increasing terrorist activities in the State. This report is scheduled to be submitted within 6 months.